Lesson notes · for you

A helper that does things

AI agents · Primary school · Lesson 1

Time
18 min

Materials
A sheet of paper and a pen; Your class timetable, or a family calendar; A friend or someone at home to play with

Learning goals

- Tell a helper that only talks from one that uses tools.
- Say the steps: listen, plan, use a tool, answer.
- Play Helper and Tool with a friend.

Activity: Helper and Tool

1. Warm-up (3 min): Write down three tools a helper could use, such as the weather, a calculator and a timetable. Say what job each one does.
2. Play (8 min): Write a timetable on a sheet; that sheet is the tool. One person asks a question about it. The helper says the plan out loud, asks the person holding the sheet, and answers from what they read out. Swap roles and play again.
3. No-tool round (4 min): This time the helper answers straight away, without asking the tool. Check the answer against the sheet.
4. Share (3 min): Say what went wrong in the no-tool round, and why a helper should answer from what the tool said.

You only need paper, a pen and a timetable or calendar. No phone is needed.

Discussion

- Which helpers have you met that only talk?
- Which tool would help you most at school?
- Why should a helper answer from what the tool said?

Check yourself

- Draw the four steps: listen, plan, tool, answer.

Try it this week
Play “Helper and Tool” with a friend or someone at home: one person asks a question, the helper makes a plan and asks the tool (someone holding the timetable), then answers only from what the tool said.

Worksheet

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

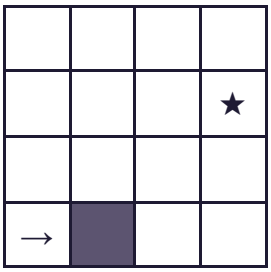
1 **A helper says it will be sunny tomorrow, but it never used the weather tool. Should you believe it?**

◯ Yes, helpers are always right ◯ Yes, because it sounds sure ◯ Not yet: it didn't check with a tool

2 **A helper is asked "What is 25 + 17?". Which of these could be its tool?**

◯ A lamp ◯ A plant ◯ A calculator

3 **A helper works in steps, like this robot. Put the cards in order so the robot reaches the star.**



Cut out cards (↑ forward, ↶ turn left, ↷ turn right) and lay out a program that takes the robot to the ★. Write it here:

4 **Put the helper's steps in order.**

☐ Make a plan

☐ Listen to the question

☐ Answer from the facts

☐ Use the weather tool

☐ Read what the tool sent back

5 **Match each question to the tool that fits.**

Will it rain tomorrow?	• • • •	The route tool
What is 17 × 23?	• • • •	The weather tool
How far is it to Dala?	• • • •	The reminder tool
Remind me about my homework	• • • •	The calculator

✎ **Think of a job at home that a helper could do with a tool. Which tool would it need? You can write a few words, or just think about it.**

Check your answers

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1 **Not yet: it didn't check with a tool**

Without the weather tool, it is only guessing.

2 **A calculator**

A calculator does one job, sums, so it is the right tool for this question.

3 **Any program that takes the robot to the ★ with 5 cards or fewer.**

Turn left to face up, go forward two squares, turn right, then go forward three squares.

4 **Top to bottom: 2, 1, 5, 3, 4**

A helper plans before it uses a tool, and it can only answer after the tool has sent back the facts.

5 **Will it rain tomorrow? — The weather tool**
What is 17 × 23? — The calculator
How far is it to Dala? — The route tool
Remind me about my homework — The reminder tool

Each tool does one job. A good helper picks the tool whose job fits the question.